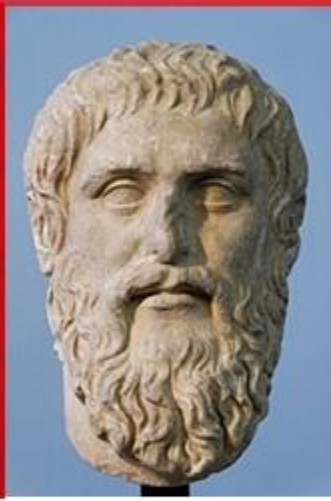
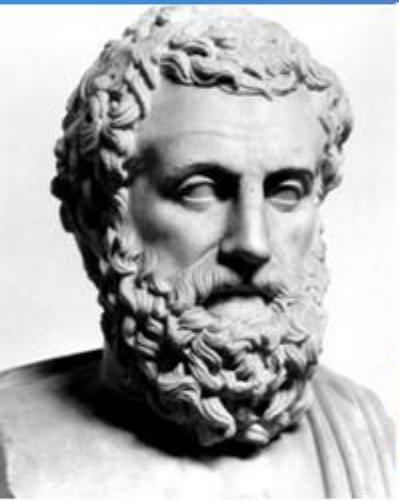


ETHICS, INTEGRITY & APTITUDE

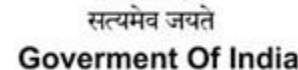


MODULE – 38

PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

- 4 It is also defined as the traditions and customs by which authorities exercise in a country with the objective of maximising welfare of people.



World bank has come out with concept of good governance in 1992 as part of aid and loan conditionality for developing nations.

Good governance has 8 important features:

1. Participatory in nature
2. Consensus oriented
3. Transparency
4. Responsiveness
5. Rule of Law
6. Economy and efficiency
7. Inclusiveness and equity
8. Accountability

There is positive correlation between good governance and developmental outcomes.



PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

Functioning of our political and administrative systems is characterized by bad governance.

Features of bad governance:

1. High levels of corruption
2. Nepotism and favouritism in administration
3. Absence of rule of law
4. High levels of secrecy in administration.
5. Complete absence of accountability mechanisms
6. Inability to resolve conflicts without resorting to violence.

7. Failure to ensure effective regulatory mechanism.
8. Centralization of power in hands of people at top.
9. Absolute monopoly of state
10. Total absence of people's participation in governance.
11. Dictatorial decision making process
12. Complete absence of grievance redressal mechanism.



ETHICAL GOVERNANCE

- 1 Carrying out administration strictly according to established ethical norms like Honesty, Empathy, Integrity, Selflessness and so on.
- 2 Ethical governance is necessary to ensure good governance. Structures can be created. Rules and regulations can be framed. But it is the values and ethics that determine functions of these structures.
- 3 Most of good governance initiatives that the country has implemented since 1990s have failed to realize outcomes because of absence of ethical governance.



PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

WHY PROBITY REQUIRED

- 1 Because **administration** perform **significant functions** with the objective of bringing about **socio-economic transformations**, they face many **challenges** both **internally** and **externally**.
- 2 Strong **moral values** are **needed** so that they can become **catalyst for change**.
- 3 They must maintain **highest ethical standards**. They must ensure **complete** probity in governance.
- 4 Absence of probity in governance can result in

- Unprofessional attitudes,
- Indiscipline,
- Inefficiency,
- Wastage of resources,
- Continuous conflict with other employees,
- Goal displacement i.e., rules and regulation become more important than output and outcomes,
- Corruption,
- Nepotism and favouritism and so on.

PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

WHAT IS PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE?

- 1 Probity (Satyanishtha in Hindi) literally means a complete and confirmed integrity; having strong moral principles.
- 2 Probity in Governance is defined as adherence to ethical and moral values like honesty, Integrity, rectitude, uprightness etc.
- 3 It is the presence of procedural integrity with high standards of ethical behaviour.
- 4 Probity in governance is multi-dimensional term involving structural and behavioural aspects of administration

- 5 Structurally, probity in governance focuses on

- Hierarchy,
- Discipline,
- Professionalism,
- Rule of law,
- Written communication,
- Rationality and so on.



PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

WHAT IS PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE?

6 Whereas **behaviour aspects** include

- Empathy,
- Commitment to public service,
- Selflessness,
- **Honesty, integrity** and so on.

7 Behavioural aspects can be learnt by civil servants by observing their **superiors**, from their **role models** and also by observing ordinary citizens.

8 Traditions and customs also play a very important role in **determining value system** of bureaucracy.

9 In **materialistic societies**, it becomes difficult to ensure probity in public or personal life.

10 Problem is **Honesty** is never rewarded whereas **corruption** is never punished.

11 **Society** recognises only **success**. Civil servants also come from same society. It becomes **extremely difficult** for them to ensure probity in governance as they can be punished by superiors for their honesty and discipline.



PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

12 On the other hand, they can get their promotions and postings easily if they join hands with political executive.

13 Morality is the inner strength of a person to resist the temptation of using the assets of organization for personal benefits where he is in a position to do so.

14 Civil servants have unlimited access to the resources of the society. It becomes almost impossible for them to resist the temptation as they are also part of materialistic societies.

15 In Ruling – Citizens are subjects to be governed;

16 In Governance – Citizens are to be empowered.

**21st Century India is still ruled by 19th Century
rules and regulations
Civil servants are not linked to performance in
India.**



PROBITY IN GOVERNANCE

WAY AHEAD

1 MORAL EDUCATION

a To make an individual high on integrity, it is necessary to provide individual with ethical training that will inspire him to improve governance.

b The moral education will surely ensure that this takes place. For example, training on the importance of avoiding bribes.

2 ACCOUNTABILITY

a Accountability reduces chances of malpractices in governance.

b When an individual is expected to give answers to higher authorities, he/she avoids performing acts that will reduce his/her position.

c This will translate into good governance. For example, Social audits ensures accountability and thus lead to probity.



accountability

business, corporate, culture, core, company, value, ideology, vision, conduct, code, industry, innovation, ethics, integrity, corporate, culture, core, company, value, ideology, vision, conduct, code, industry, innovation, ethics, integrity

3

INFORMATION SHARING AND TRANSPARENCY IN GOVERNANCE

a

Sharing information and transparency are indispensable pillars of good governance that compel the state and civil society to focus on results, seek clear objectives, develop effective strategies, and monitor and report on performance.

4

ACCESS TO INFORMATION

a

Many laws were enumerated to bring probity in governance for sharing information to the public by putting information in the public domain and which includes the following:

- Right to information Act.
- Ombudsman Office in the local/state level.
- Accountability bill for disclosure of Income and Assets.
- Records Management laws.



5 GRIEVANCE REDRESSAL

- a**
- Easy access of **government officials** to the public is important for **grievance redressal**.
 - It can be ensured through:

- i. Availability of Contact numbers of senior servants to Public
- ii. Details in Departmental websites
- iii. Facilitation counters for citizens
- iv. Assessment and Monitoring

- 6** Ensure **Probity in governance** with help of **code of conduct** and **code of ethics**.



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